

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** D

Options: A) The participants should be selected at random.; B) It is an example of a formal research tool for practitioners.; C) The information can be generalized to describe a larger population.; D) The findings generate qualitative data that can be used to develop surveys.

Note: Focus group research provides in-depth qualitative insights into participants' attitudes and behaviors, which can inform the development of structured surveys that capture these insights quantitatively.

2. **Answer:** B

Options: A) teamwork; B) specialisation; C) project work groups; D) multi-skilled employees

Note: Functional structures in organizations promote specialization by grouping employees based on their specific skills and expertise, allowing for increased efficiency and productivity within distinct areas of work.

3. **Answer:** B

Options: A) Perception.; B) Personality.; C) Learning.; D) Memory.

Note: Personality is the consistent pattern of thoughts, feelings, and behaviors that influence how individuals respond to their environment, making it the correct answer for this definition.

4. **Answer:** B

Options: A) Technological environment.; B) Legal environment.; C) Economic environment.; D) Ecological environment.

Note: The ban on tobacco advertising in many countries reflects the legal environment's impact on public health policies aimed at reducing smoking prevalence and protecting consumers from the dangers associated with tobacco use.

5. **Answer:** C

Options: A) Task identity; B) Autonomy; C) Reward; D) Feedback

Note: The job characteristics model focuses on five core dimensions-skill variety, task identity, task significance, autonomy, and feedback-but does not include reward as one of its characteristics.

True / False

6. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Community focus groups are considered external factors in a firm's public relations situation analysis because they represent the perspectives and opinions of the community outside the organization rather than internal elements of the firm.

7. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: A social enterprise is designed to address social issues while generating profit, thereby creating positive social benefits for the community through its business operations.

8. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The statement is false because many consulting firms not only provide strategic advice but also engage in executing research projects and implementing solutions for their clients.

9. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Perishability refers to the characteristic of services that they cannot be stored or saved for later use, rather than the inability to separate the service from its provider.

10. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Virtual teams often face challenges in conflict resolution due to the lack of non-verbal cues and the potential for miscommunication in digital formats, which can hinder effective direct communication methods like video calls.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** The five-step model for circular evaluation proposed by Watson and Noble (2005) emphasizes an iterative approach to assessing business strategies, with pre-testing as a crucial initial phase. Pre-testing strategies and tactics allow organizations to gather preliminary data on potential outcomes before full implementation, effectively minimizing risks and optimizing resource allocation. This phase helps in identifying any flaws or unexpected challenges early in the process, ensuring that adjustments can be made based on empirical evidence rather than assumptions. By integrating pre-testing into the circular evaluation model, businesses can enhance decision-making and foster a culture of continuous improvement, ultimately leading to more successful outcomes. Thus, the significance of pre-testing within this framework cannot be overstated, as it lays the groundwork for informed evaluations and strategic refinements.

Note: correct because it accurately identifies the role of pre-testing in the circular evaluation model as a vital step for reducing risks and refining strategies by allowing organizations to assess potential outcomes before full implementation.

12. **Answer:** Conducting a situation analysis during the program definition stage of the planning process in business administration is crucial for defining the program effec-

tively. This analysis allows businesses to assess internal strengths and weaknesses, as well as external opportunities and threats, providing a comprehensive understanding of the current market landscape. By identifying these factors, organizations can tailor their programs to meet specific needs and align with their strategic goals. Furthermore, a thorough situation analysis aids in risk management by anticipating potential challenges, ensuring that the program is not only well-defined but also resilient to external changes. Ultimately, this foundational step enhances decision-making and leads to more successful program outcomes.

Note: correct because a situation analysis enables businesses to critically evaluate their internal and external environments, ensuring that program definitions are strategically aligned with market demands and organizational objectives.